

Displacement Risk Analysis in Dallas County

1. Introduction

Gentrification and rising housing costs are reshaping Dallas County, putting thousands of long-time residents at risk of displacement. A recent report found that one in five Dallas neighborhoods is in the early stages of gentrification, leading to increased property values and rent hikes that disproportionately impact low-income communities (Dallas News, 2024). This shift is particularly concerning for renters, who lack the stability of homeownership and are most vulnerable to eviction. As luxury developments replace affordable housing, many working-class families, particularly Black and Hispanic residents, are being priced out of their own neighborhoods (NBC DFW, 2024). The affordability crisis is expected to worsen, with projections indicating that by 2032, the typical Dallas renter will only be able to afford 21% of available rental units, making displacement an increasingly urgent issue (Hockaday Forecast, 2024).

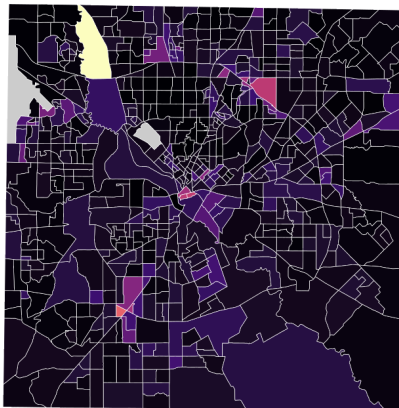
This study assesses displacement risk in Dallas County by integrating U.S. Census data with eviction filings to identify populations most vulnerable to housing instability. The key factors considered in this analysis include eviction rate, which measures the proportion of eviction filings relative to the total population, homeownership risk, which reflects the percentage of non-homeowners as an inverse indicator of housing stability, and rent burden, which captures the share of renters allocating more than 30% of their income to rent. By aggregating these variables, a displacement risk measure is constructed to evaluate which demographic groups face the highest risk. The analysis focuses on disparities between renters and homeowners, racial and ethnic disparities, the effects on children and seniors, and the relationships between key displacement indicators. The objective of this study is to provide data-driven insights to inform housing policy interventions aimed at mitigating displacement.

2. Displacement Risk Calculation

Displacement Risk = $\text{eviction rate} + (\text{rent burden} * (1 - \text{homeownership rate}))$

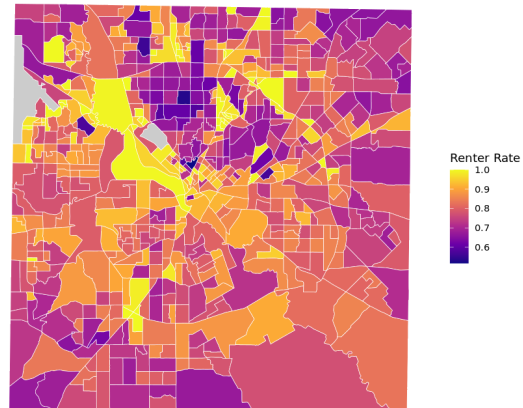
This formula ensures that rent burden disproportionately impacts areas with higher renter populations, aligning with displacement vulnerability. The rationale behind this approach is that eviction rates indicate immediate risk, rent burden measures financial strain on tenants, and homeownership rate inversely affects displacement likelihood. By integrating these factors, we capture a more comprehensive picture of displacement risk across different neighborhoods.

Eviction Rate by Census Tract in Dallas County (2021)
Higher eviction rates concentrated in renter-heavy areas



Data Source: ACS 2021 & Eviction Filings

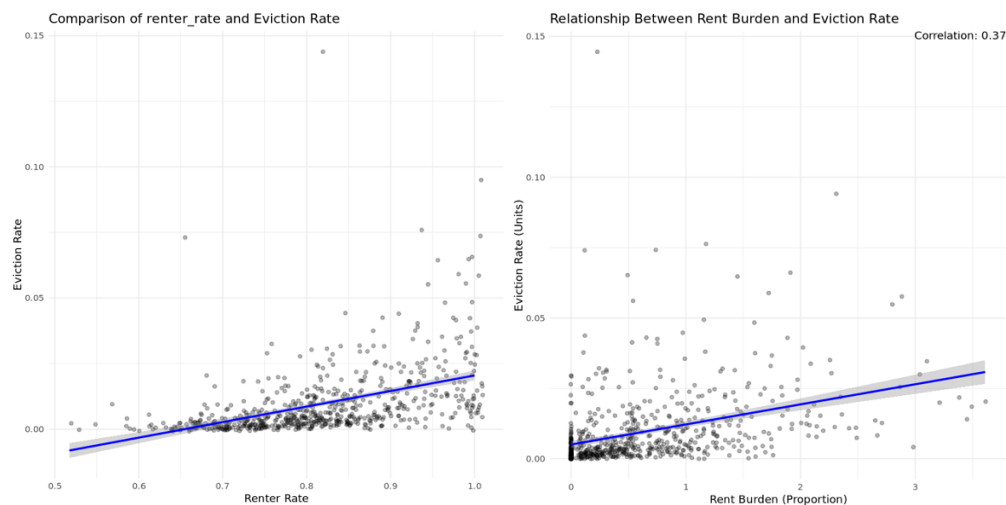
Renter Rate by Census Tract in Dallas County (2021)
Higher renter concentration in certain neighborhoods



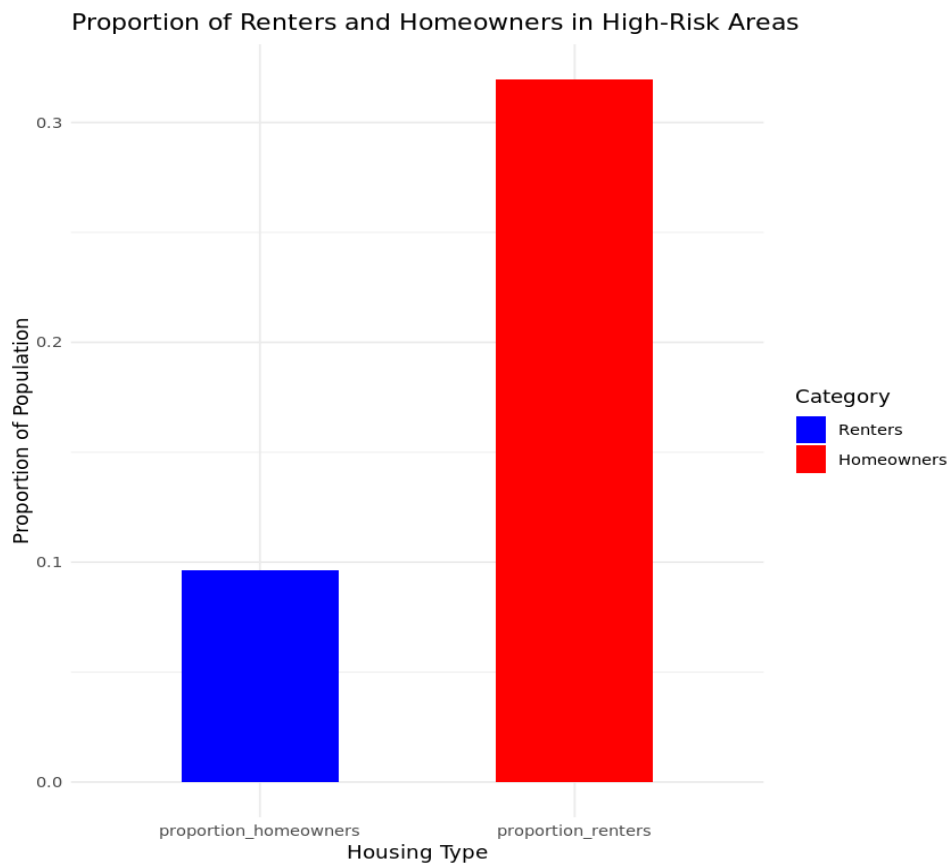
Data Source: ACS 2021 & Eviction Filings

3. Risk Factor Correlation

The scatter plots provide insight into the relationships between key displacement risk factors. The first graph demonstrates a positive correlation between renter rate and eviction rate, suggesting that neighborhoods with a higher proportion of renters tend to experience more evictions. This trend aligns with expectations, as renters face greater housing instability than homeowners, making them more susceptible to displacement. The second graph illustrates the relationship between rent burden and eviction rate, with a correlation of 0.37, indicating a moderate positive association. This means that as rent burden increases—where tenants allocate a larger share of their income to rent—eviction rates tend to rise. The positive slope in both graphs reinforce the idea that financial strain and a lack of homeownership stability are key contributors to eviction risk, highlighting the importance of policies aimed at reducing rent burdens and strengthening tenant protections in renter-heavy areas.

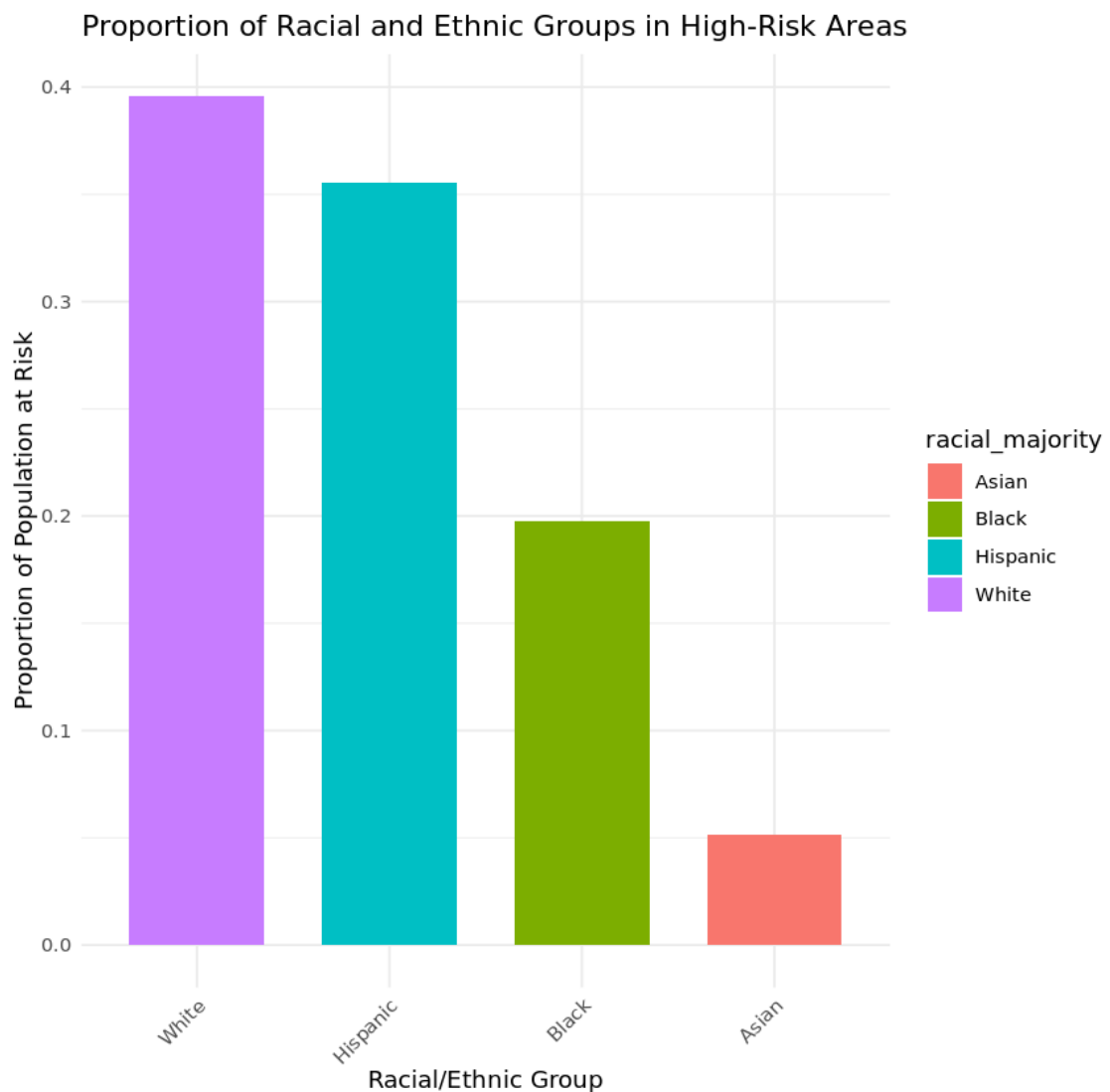


4. Homeowner VS Renter



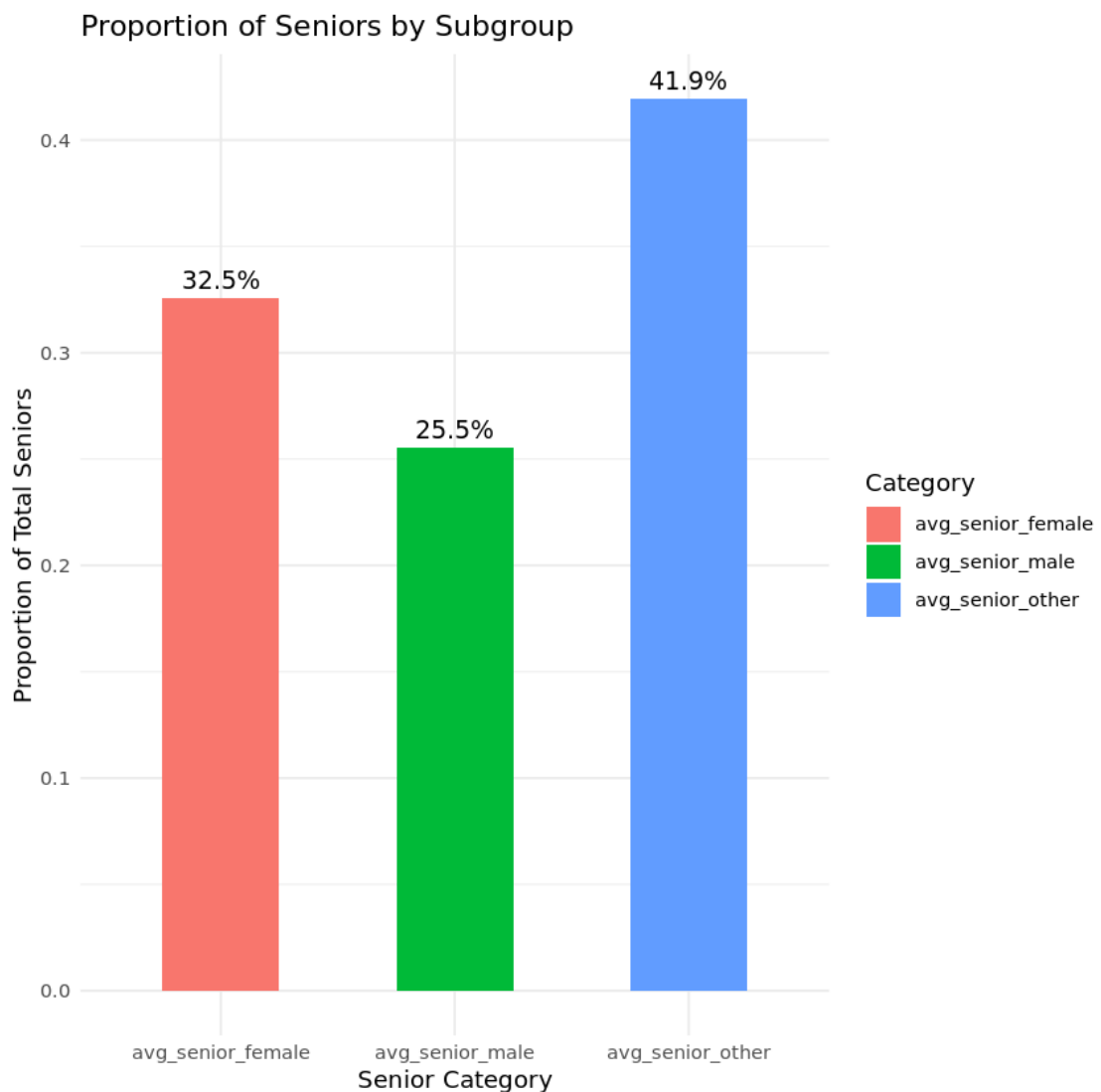
The bar chart highlights the stark contrast between renters and homeowners in high-risk displacement areas. According to the data, 32% of the population in these areas are renters, while only 9.64% are homeowners. This disparity reinforces the vulnerability of renter-heavy communities, as renters face higher eviction rates and are more susceptible to financial instability due to fluctuating rental prices. In contrast, homeownership provides a greater degree of housing stability, shielding residents from sudden rent increases or eviction threats. The overwhelming presence of renters in high-risk areas suggests that displacement pressures—such as rising rent burdens and eviction risks—are disproportionately affecting these communities, making policies that support affordable housing and tenant protections crucial for maintaining housing stability.

5. Race and Ethnicity



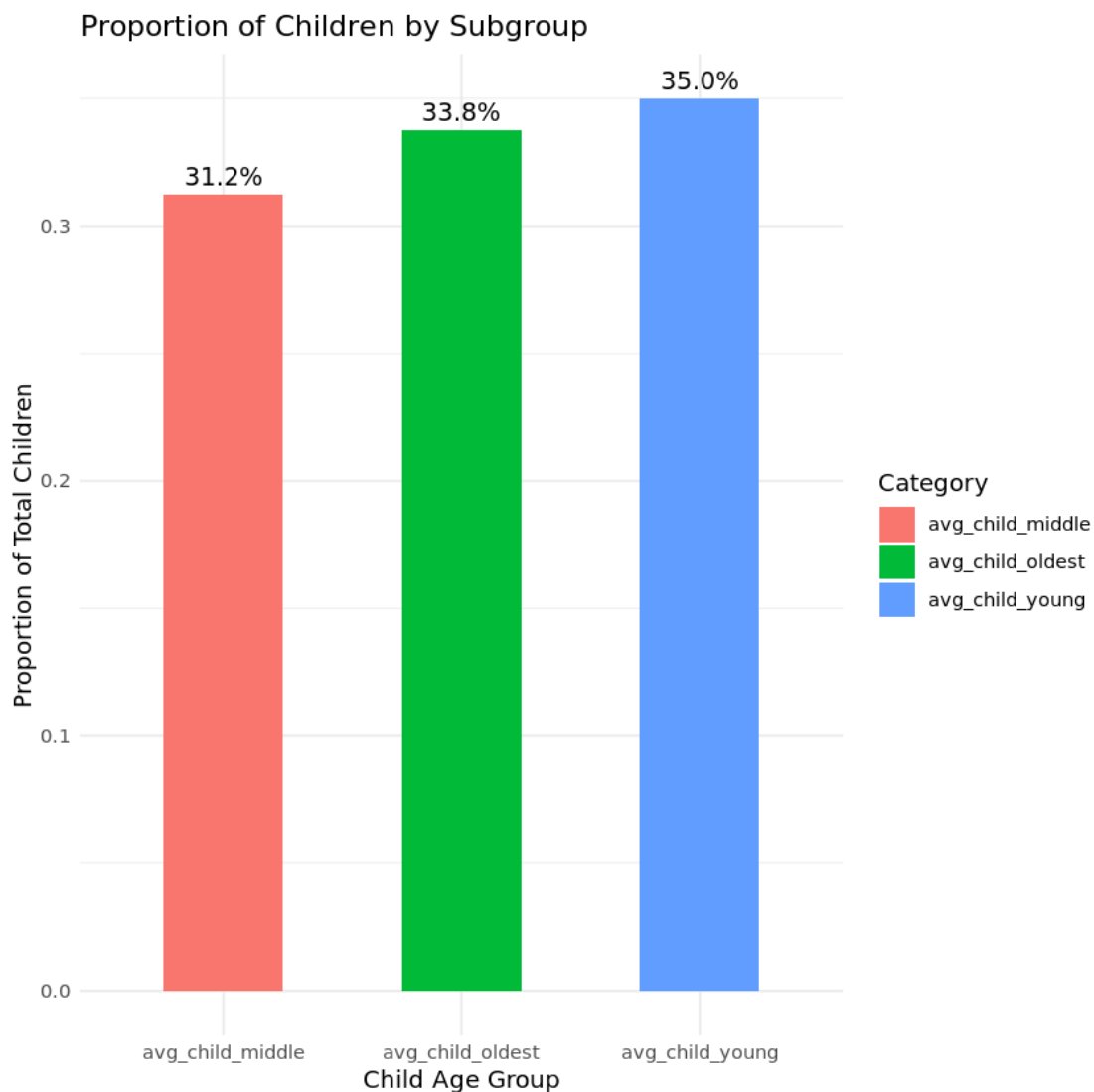
Displacement in high-risk areas isn't limited to a single racial or ethnic group, but it does affect some communities more than others. White (39.6%) and Hispanic (35.5%) residents make up the largest share of those at risk, followed by Black (19.8%) and Asian (5.1%) populations. While displacement pressures touch all racial groups, Hispanic and Black communities face disproportionate risks, likely due to lower homeownership rates, rent burden, and economic instability. On the other hand, the lower percentage of Asian residents at risk may be due to higher homeownership rates or concentration in areas with more housing stability. However, the presence of White residents in high-risk areas suggests that gentrification and rising housing costs are impacting a much broader group than just traditionally marginalized communities. The data makes it clear that housing affordability and stability are growing concerns across racial lines, reinforcing the need for targeted housing policies, stronger tenant protections, and efforts to prevent mass displacement in rapidly changing neighborhoods.

6. Seniors and Displacement Risk



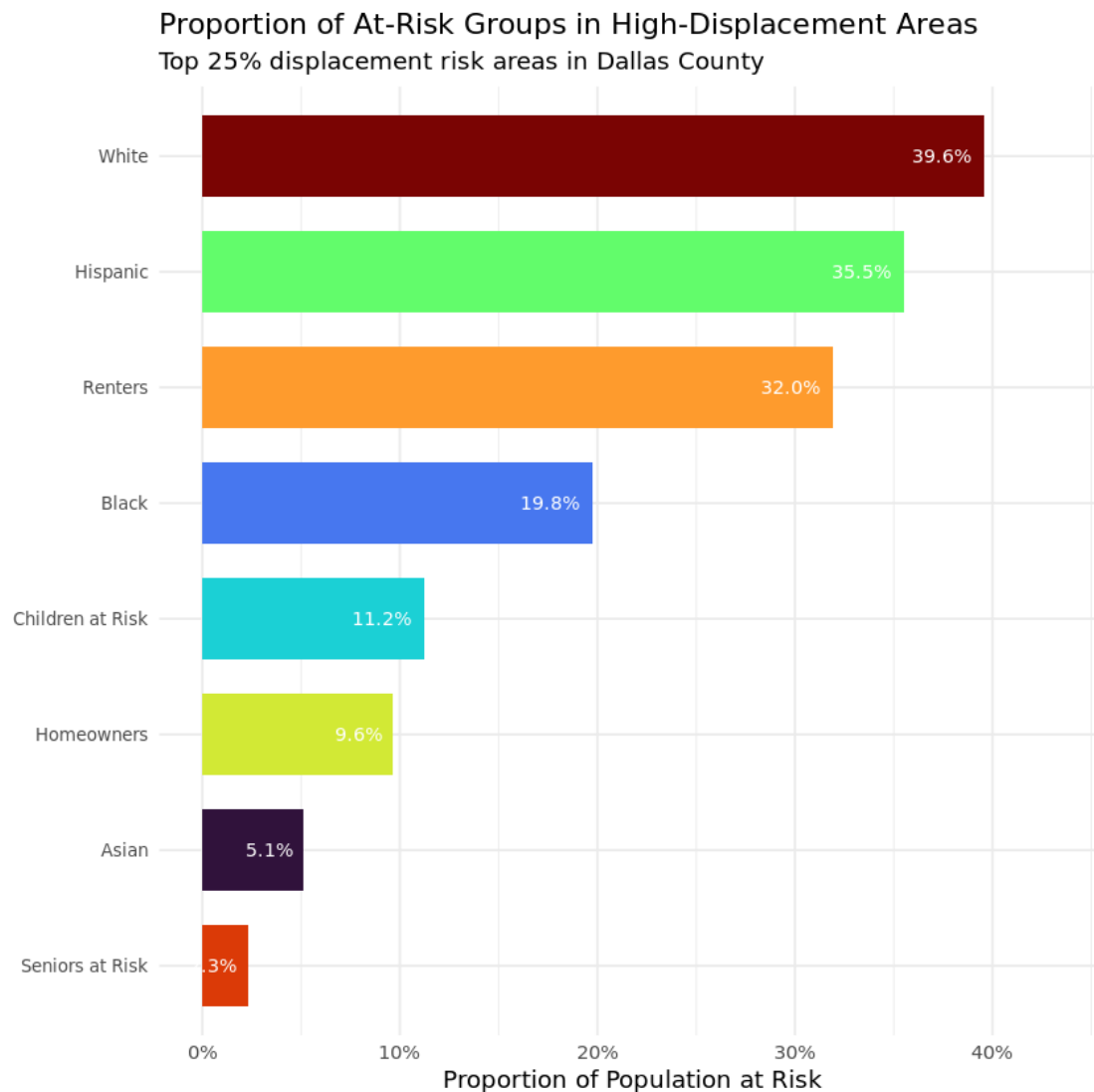
While much of the displacement conversation focuses on renters and working-age populations, seniors also face unique housing challenges, particularly in high-risk areas. The data suggests that senior males experience slightly higher displacement risk compared to senior females and other senior groups, with their proportion increasing from 25% in lower-risk areas to 27.1% in high-risk areas. This may be due to financial instability, lack of social support, or fewer long-term housing arrangements among older men. In contrast, senior females and other seniors see a slight decline in high-risk areas, suggesting that they may have greater housing stability, potentially through homeownership, family support, or social programs. However, despite these small shifts, the overall proportions remain relatively stable, indicating that while seniors are not the most at-risk group for displacement, they are not immune to its effects. Rising housing costs, fixed incomes, and limited affordable senior housing can still put older adults at risk of losing stable housing, particularly as gentrification and rent increases continue.

8. Children and Displacement Risk



Children are particularly vulnerable to displacement, as housing instability can disrupt their education, social networks, and overall well-being. The data indicates that young children (35%) make up the largest proportion of total children in high-risk areas, followed closely by older children (33.8%) and middle-aged children (31.2%). When comparing high-risk areas to lower-risk areas, the proportion of young children increases from 34.5% to 36.5%, while middle-aged children see a slight increase from 31.1% to 31.6%, and older children decrease from 34.4% to 32.0%. These shifts suggest that households with younger children may be at greater risk of displacement, possibly due to financial strain on families with younger dependents who require more caregiving resources. The decline in older children in high-risk areas may indicate that families with older children are more likely to relocate to areas with better school access and stability if faced with displacement pressures.

9. At-Risk Groups in High-Displacement Areas



Displacement risk is not evenly distributed across demographics, with renters, racial minorities, children, and seniors facing varying levels of vulnerability. The data shows that renters make up 32% of the population in high-displacement-risk areas, while homeowners account for only 9.64%, reinforcing that non-homeowners are the most at risk of being forced out due to financial pressures and eviction risks. Among racial and ethnic groups, White (39.6%) and Hispanic (35.5%) residents represent the largest share of at-risk populations, followed by Black (19.8%) and Asian (5.1%) populations. This suggests that displacement is not limited to minority groups but affects a broad range of communities, likely due to rising housing costs and gentrification pressures.

Children and seniors also face unique risks, though to different extents. Children make up 11.2% of the at-risk population, indicating that families with young dependents are more likely to experience housing instability, which can disrupt education and community ties. In contrast, seniors account for only 2.3% of the at-risk group, suggesting that older adults may

have more housing security, possibly due to homeownership, fixed incomes, or social safety nets.

7. Conclusion

Renters are at significantly higher displacement risk than homeowners, with Black and Hispanic populations disproportionately impacted. Children also face higher displacement risks compared to seniors. One of the major contributing factors is rent burden, which exacerbates the vulnerability of low-income renters. Additionally, rent burden and homeownership risk are strongly correlated, reinforcing the precarious conditions in renter-heavy areas.

To address these challenges, stronger tenant protections are needed to prevent evictions in high-risk renter communities. Expanding affordable housing can help reduce rent burden, while financial assistance programs for families and seniors can contribute to housing stability. Targeted interventions in renter-heavy neighborhoods—where rent burden and eviction rates are highest—are crucial for mitigating displacement risks.

9. References

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